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Chapter 1

Application Manager Basics



Prerequisites

You should be familiar with your PC or terminal and its controls.

Certain keys on the keyboard are different, depending on whether you are using a PC Client or an AS400 terminal. These keys are:

AS400	Windows
Shift - Roll Up	Page Down
Shift - Roll Down	Page Up
Function Keys	Function keys F1 - F12 displayed
F1 - F24 displayed	F13 - F24 accessed by using Shift key to increment the Function Key value by 12, for example, Shift+F1=F13
Field Exit	Right Ctrl Key (but can change depending on key mapping).
Insert	Insert
Delete	Delete
Reset	Left Ctrl key

You should be familiar with signing off and onto your server and have a good knowledge of the Server-based software in the following areas:

- Interact with displays.
- Use Help.
- Enter control commands and procedure commands.
- Call utilities.
- Respond to messages.

System Conventions

To avoid the repetition of standard facilities and procedures, certain common routines and functions are referred to by the following conventions:

Signing Off

Enter 90 in the command line of a menu to Sign Off the system and return to the initial Sign On menu provided by the Server's operating software.

Enter Key

In conformance with IBM's SAA standards the **Enter** key is used to update the current record or move to the next screen; for example, in the case of selecting an option.



Note: In some instances, where updating the record may give rise to complex consequences, you may be asked to confirm the request.

Environment Code

Each Software module or application belongs to a specified environment.

For example, you may wish to have a live environment and a test environment for your Financial Systems. The environment code is used to differentiate between these environments.

An application is identified using the keys:

Application ID for example, GL - General Ledger.

Environment for example, TST - Test Environment.

Release for example, 03 - Version 3.



Note: Modules are shipped with a blank environment code.

Selecting Menu Options

All menus and sub-menus used by System Manager and Developer modules provide you with the facility to:

- Enter option numbers and then press the **Enter** key.
- Move the action bar to the required option and press the **Enter** key. The action bar can be moved using the Page Up and Down keys.
- You can go directly to menu options by entering \n. Where n is the option number. If there are sub-menus then you can enter \n\n.
- The menus of other System Manager and developer modules can be accessed directly by entering \a. Where a is a single character module ID
 - \a Application Manager
 - \c Administration Functions
 - \f File Migration Utility
 - \h Housekeeping

- \i IPG/400
- \m Machine Manager
- \n Network Manager
- \r IRG/400 (Report Generator)
- \v VIEWfinder.

System Manager

System Manager is the generic name for the following modules:

- Application Manager.
- Machine Manager.
- Housekeeping.
- Networking.
- Administration Functions.



To access System Manager enter:
IPGCFP4/STRM400



Note: To access System Manager when you sign on to the Server, change your user profile so that STRM400P is the initial program to call. Enter the command:

```
CHGUSRPRF  
USRPRF(uuuuuuuuuu)INLPGM(IPGCFP4/STR  
M400P)
```

Where uuuuuuuuuu is the user profile to change.

Application Manager

Application Manager has been developed to provide advanced system integration and to facilitate the creation and maintenance of security-conscious menu systems.

For users of standard applications, the product is ready-to-use, that is it is already aware of the applications it has been designed to support.

Use Application Manager to:

- Interchange between application areas more easily.
- Create free-format user-defined menus.
- Provide password protection at menu option level.
- Provide password protection at function level.
- Display current system processing, that is, which terminal is processing which function.
- Add tailor-made functions to user-defined menus.
- Work in Expert Mode of menu operation.
- Control Job Queues and Print Queues for submitted jobs.
- Provide exclusive-use-needed control over applications.
- Provide control of the multi-language environment for all standard applications.

Application Manager eases the problem of application interchange. It can provide on a single menu a series of options regardless of the module to which they belong. It can also be used to restrict access at company (for multi-company products), application, function and menu option level. Application Manager achieves this by providing a simple method of tailor-made menu generation.



Note: Since details from the user profile are used within other System Manager modules, you maintain user profiles in Administration Functions. Reference to the user profile is made where it is relevant to Application Manager.

Menus

Application integration is achieved via the generation of tailor-made menus. Application Manager provides total flexibility in its approach to the building of menus, and thus provides a choice as to the accessibility and content of the user menu.

The user has total flexibility with the menu layout. Most field-level display attributes can be used (for example, highlighting, underlining, and colour), and the menus are in no way pre-structured as, for example, two columns. Therefore users have total freedom to lay out the menu display exactly as they wish.

The use of function keys is totally soft-coded, and can be associated with any action that is required.

Access Control

The accessibility feature controls which companies (for multi-company environments), which applications, and which functions within applications, a user can access. You can restrict the content of the menu content to those functions to which the user is authorised. Access to functions for which the user has not been granted rights of usage is inhibited at execution time.

This is achieved in two stages:

- At user level, by selecting the menus and menu activities to which the user is authorised.
- At application level, by selecting specific tasks from an application to which the user is allowed access, and within which companies. For example, the user's profile can be set up to allow access to all enquiry menus and all enquiry tasks in a selected application.

Tasks

Each activity carried out under the control of Application Manager is defined as a task. This describes, for example, which program should be called to perform this activity and whether it is a batch (submitted) or an interactive task. An application may be thought of as a set of tasks, logically grouped together. For example, Accounts Receivable, Sales Order Processing, and so on. To use an entire application, a user must be granted rights of usage for all the tasks for that application.

A single menu can feature tasks from across many applications and thus provide a seamless user environment.

User Profile

In addition to their Server user profile, each user has a System Manager user profile for Application Manager. This controls:

1. The default sign-on menu.
2. In a multi-company environment, the default company assigned.
3. The default job and print queues. These can be overridden at company and task level. For example, you can print invoices on a dedicated printer.
4. Whether the user is authorised to enter commands.
5. Whether an alternative language is used.

In addition, user authorisation to other menus can be granted and authority to application-defined tasks and the companies within applications can be given.

Library Lists

Library lists are set up within the system by reference to a set of standard library list files which are supplied with the system. These library lists are set up to cater for all standard usages of the applications, but the user can maintain them to allow for modifications to their own applications. Each application has its own set of library lists. Library lists can be set up to cater for test or training environments where impact on the live data must be eliminated.

Application Profile

Each application must have its own application profile, defining the version and name of the application in use. The application profile controls the default library list used, and whether or not a specific application day-end program is required.

Management And Control

Application Manager provides automatic error logging. In the event of an error occurring whilst running an application, the system displays a message, informing the user of an abnormal termination. In addition to this, the system writes an error record to its files. This file can be enquired upon by the user. The information displayed can be used to determine the cause of the error. The error file can also be printed and, if necessary, sent to the software support organisation.

You can use Application Manager to allocate any or all applications for exclusive use, for example for copying files to offline storage. You can determine who is signed on to an application and can then send a message to any or all users telling them to sign off the system.

Any user attempting to sign on to an allocated application receives a message telling them that the application is not available, and they cannot access any functions within the application.

Advanced Menu Functions

In addition to providing menus from which the user can enter options or select function keys, you are also able to use menus in expert mode.

If an application has a hierarchical menu structure you can enter the menu name in the menu option field to go directly to that menu. If you know the specific option number, you can enter this and the menu name to directly access the task required.

If you cannot find a specific task by navigating the menu you can use the search facility. You can enter a word from the task's description and a list of tasks containing the word, and which you have authorisation for, is displayed for you to select from.

In addition you are able to set up synonyms to reflect your business. You can associate the word Item with the words Part, Product, and Assembly. Once you have set up your own synonyms the task searching facility is used and is transparent to the user.



To access Application Manager, enter 4 in the option field and press **Enter**, or use Page Up to move the action bar so that Application Manager is highlighted and press **Enter**.